

The Wide Post

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FRONT PAGE

Is AI really coming for architects' jobs?

Dezeen staff · Dezeen Architecture

In the latest episode of Dezeen Weekly , we discuss a study indicating that architecture is highly exposed to automation and talk about the winner of this year's Pritzker Architecture Prize .

How worried should architects be about large language models taking their jobs? How did the Pritzker Architecture Prize make us look silly this week? And what is “bio-upcycling”?

In this episode, Dezeen features editor Nat Barker and design editor Jennifer Hahn consider a controversial labour impact study by AI company Anthropic .

Also, they reflect on the surprise announcement about this year's Pritzker laureate, Smiljan Radić . Finally, they discuss the news that scientists have managed to produce a Parkinson's drug from waste plastic with the help of bacteria.

Dezeen Weekly is an original Dezeen podcast in which two of our journalists talk about the key design and architecture stories of the week. Listen to the latest episode using the player above or on your favourite podcast app, including Spotify and Apple Podcasts .

The post Is AI really coming for architects' jobs? appeared first on Dezeen .

FEATURES

Heliotrope tucks False Bay house into rocky site on a Washington island

Jenna McKnight · Dezeen Architecture

Architectural studio Heliotrope took a “site-sensitive approach” while designing a vacation house in the Pacific Northwest, resulting in a bow tie-shaped plan and knotty cedar cladding.

The house is located on San Juan Island in the Salish Sea, situated about 90 miles (145 kilometers) from Seattle. Part of Washington State, the island is reached by boat or sea-plane.

The clients are from Seattle and have friends with homes on the island. They wanted a family vacation home that would be suitable for entertaining guests and could shift to more frequent use as the clients age.

False Bay is a cedar-clad vacation home on an island in Washington

Respecting the context and minimising energy consumption were key concerns for the clients.

“They shared the firm’s interest in a site-sensitive approach to the design, as well as a commitment to net-zero energy,” said Seattle-based studio Heliotrope.

The site posed challenges, as the house is located on a rocky shoreline exposed to rain and wind that travels down the Strait of Juan de Fuca from the Pacific Ocean.

It was nestled into the rocky landscape

Moreover, the property has rocky outcrops that made “sitting the home a bit of a puzzle”, the team said.

The studio conceived a sculptural house with a bow-tie-shaped footprint, allowing the building to be tucked into the rocky site, informed by the famed Sea Ranch development in northern California, known for its “windswept building forms and weathered materials”.

The home has a bow tie-shaped footprint

Facades are clad in cedar with a semi-transparent stain, giving the wood a bleached appearance. Cedar is known for being highly resistant to insects and rot.

The team used tight-knot cedar, which has small- to medium-sized knots that give the wood a more rustic appearance than “clear” cedar.

Read:

Heliotrope perches Buck Mountain Cabin over forested site in Washington State

Within the 2,474-square-foot (230-square-metre) house, there is a clear separation between public and private areas.

One side of the plan holds the social zone – a kitchen, dining area and living room. The other contains a primary suite and guest suites on the ground level, and a loft and reading nook on the upper level.

Warm-toned wood was used throughout the interior

Interior finishes include an abundance of warm-toned wood, which helps create a cosy atmosphere.

Pre-finished engineered oak was used for the flooring, and cedar was used for certain walls and ceilings. Glazed-brick tile is found behind a wood stove in the living area.

A reading nook overlooks the surroundings

Large windows offer immersive views of the landscape.

The architects focused on providing views of the water to the south and a rocky outcrop to the north. The house was kept mostly opaque on the east and western sides, which face neighbouring homes.

The kitchen opens onto an outdoor terrace

Along the front elevation, a terrace sits within a gap formed between the house and rocky mound. The outdoor space is protected from the wind, which is “an important feature on such an exposed site”.

Elements that help reduce energy consumption include an airtight building envelope, and a high-efficiency heating system with heat-recovery ventilation. An 8kW solar array helps generate power for the home, which is also tied into the island’s electric grid.

Other projects by Heliotrope include a sensitive extension to a 1930s home that was originally built by a Norwegian ship captain and a house for art collectors clad in dark metal and white stucco.

Project credits:

Architect: Heliotrope

Heliotrope design team: Joe Herrin (principal in charge), Chris Wong (project manager), Rachel Belcher (designer)

Interiors: Heliotrope with owners

Contractor: DME Construction

Landscape: Garden Artisan Landscapes

Structural engineer: Swenson Say Faget

Mechanical engineer: Beyond Efficiency

Geotechnical engineer: Stratum Group

The post Heliotrope tucks False Bay house into rocky site on a Washington island appeared first on Dezeen.

A thesis week

Petr Mitrichev · Petr Mitrichev (competitive programming)

Atto Round 1, also known as Codeforces Round 1041, was the main event of the week (problems , results , top 5 on the left, analysis). With problem H turning out way easier than the problemsetters have expected, the top places were decided on problem G concerning permutations and their compositions, which for me was just very hard to load into RAM to even think about it :) At the end of the contest I came up with a randomized solution that takes 15 random permutations and asks all their cyclic shifts. It actually passed G1 in upsolving, but during the round I did not manage to find all off-by-one and permutation-instead-of-inverse bugs. But even in upsolving it seemed hopeless for G2 where we only get to take 10 such permutations.

It turns out that Kevin has won the round with exactly the same solution. To pass G2, he tried 1000 different random sets of 10 permutations before starting to ask questions, and chose the set that gives the least collisions. This turned out to be borderline good enough, and 4 submissions that differed only in the random seed (diff on the right) sealed the deal. Well done Kevin, and also well done Jiangly on solving G2 in the “on paper” way :)

I got my share of successful randomized solving in problem H, where after being stuck for a while I decided to submit a solution that took edges that can definitely be taken, and when there is no such edge, took a more or less random edge and continued, and then repeated this process until the time runs out. This should be roughly the same as backtracking but even simpler to implement, and I expected that with $n=30$ it has a high change of passing, and indeed it did from the first attempt in which I fixed all bugs.

It is curious that neither problemsetters nor myself were able to see:

1) the relatively standard dynamic programming solution for the problem that takes advantage of the fact that from every subtree of the DFS tree we have at most 5 backward edges, and therefore can just add the state of all those edges to the dynamic programming state.

2) the non-bipartite matching solution that does not even rely on the additional “at most 5” property from the problem statement: the problem statement essentially asks for maximum matching, but where each vertex can be used twice instead of once, so we can just duplicate the vertices and be done.

Point 2 is even more bizarre in my case, since my masters thesis 18 years ago was on a more general version of exactly this problem, 2-path-packings. The thesis was in Russian and I don't think it is published anywhere, but it is roughly equivalent to chapter 3 “O(mn)-time algorithm” in this paper . So the matching interpretation should really have been obvious to me, even after 18 years :)

Thanks for reading, and check back next week!

Eight contemporary houses raised on stilts

Tom Ravenscroft · Dezeen Architecture

Whether to make sloped sites level, prevent flooding or reduce impact on natural surroundings, houses on stilts are being built around the world. Here are eight of the best contemporary examples.

House in the Delta by MAPA, Argentina

Raised on stilts to protect from periodic flooding on its riverside site near Buenos Aires, House in the Delta was the first Passivhaus-certified home built in Argentina.

Architectural studio MAPA described the home as “an amphibious house – built high above the ground to coexist with the periodic flooding on the banks of the Paraná Mini”.

[Find out more about House in the Delta ›](#)

Prat House, by ERRE Arquitectos, Chile

Located in Matanzas, Chile, the 128-square-metre Prat House was designed by Raimundo Gutiérrez of ERRE Arquitectos to take advantage of its coastal site.

The entire single-storey seaside house was elevated on steel stilts, with a raised walkway and timber steps providing access.

[Find out more about Prat House ›](#)

Constructed using predominantly light-coloured timber to help it blend with its surroundings, Yngsjö was built as a retreat from city life for a Swedish family based in London.

Located close to the shores of the Baltic Sea, the house is designed to sit lightly on the site with over half the structure raised on slender steel pillars.

[Find out more about Yngsjö ›](#)

Architecture studios Jaime Prous Architects and Pineda & Monedero raised this metal-clad home on metal stilts above a steeply sloping site to the east of Barcelona.

Created for a retired couple who wanted an escape from the city, Casa 144° is lifted off the ground to minimise its impact on the landscape.

[Find out more about Casa 144° ›](#)

Described by its architect as “a contemporary chalet in harmony with its environment”, this cedar-clad residence was raised above a sloped site overlooking the St Lawrence River in Québec.

Quinzhee Architecture designed the 129-square-metre ski house to take advantage of its site and surrounding views.

[Find out more about Residence Chez Léon ›](#)

The aptly named Hole with the House Around comprises a series of boxy volumes raised on stilts surrounding a central void.

Architecture studio ElasticoFarm designed the structure as an extension to an existing 1970s house surrounded by trees in an Italian park in Cambiano, a town to the southeast of Turin.

[Find out more about Hole with the House Around ›](#)

Saunders Architecture designed this house overlooking a lake in Norway for the descendants of Norwegian composer Edvard Grieg.

Named Villa Grieg, the house combines a two-bedroom home with a music studio. The sloped music studio sits on the ground floor, with stairs leading up to the raised home that winds around a central void.

[Find out more about Villa Grieg ›](#)

The majority of this angular, lily-shaped home was raised on stilts to prevent the unnecessary removal of trees from its site in a lush Brazilian forest.

According to the studio, the black stilts that support the house were placed at “random” to emulate how trees grow in a forest.

[Find out more about Casa Açucena ›](#)

The post Eight contemporary houses raised on stilts appeared first on Dezeen .

Verge Select connects three weathering-steel volumes for Ontario painting studio

Ellen Eberhardt · Dezeen Architecture

Canadian design studio Verge Select has designed a studio for painter Janna Watson in Ontario, composed of three square volumes fused together to form a secluded forest retreat.

The Grey County studio is located in the county of the same name in Ontario, and, unlike a second, more urban studio operated by Watson, provides a space that “slows time”.

Verge Select has completed a painter’s studio in Ontario

Located in a forested glade, the structure is composed of three square volumes of varying size. They are slightly askew of one another and fuse where they meet.

The entire studio is clad in weathering steel, which will patina over time and “allow the building to recede chromatically into the forest floor” according to Verge Select.

The structure is clad in weathering steel

Watson’s programmatic needs largely informed the distinct shape.

“The studio takes shape as three distinct yet connected outcrops each responding to Watson’s brief for service functions, a light-filled workspace, and a flexible zone for photography and rest,” said the studio.

An elevated steel catwalk leads to an entrance

“The volumes nest around a central service core, opening outward through generous glazing that frames views of moss-covered stone and woodland canopy.”

On the interior, two of the cubes are largely open-plan, while the other is separated by a wall.

Another door leads into the forest

Watson’s painting area sits in the middle volume, surrounded by wide-open glazing. On one side, the central space steps up into the lounge area, while the service wing is off to the other side.

This service space includes a washing area tucked into a sharp corner, and also a bathroom shaped like a right triangle.

The central volume is wide open and wrapped in floor-to-ceiling windows

Across a central corridor is the main entrance to the studio via a steel catwalk, while a door on the other side of the structure also leads outside.

“Two arrival sequences – one compressed and inward-facing, the other emerging from the forest via a steel catwalk

– establish a rhythm of transition that echoes the artist’s working process,” said the studio.

A wash area is tucked into one corner

The studio’s ceilings reach ten feet high at their tallest, and are lined with “a gallery-style lighting system” for Watson’s work.

The space also contains a wood-burning fireplace and reflective, contemporary lounge chairs by designer Paolo Ferrari.

Read:

Cordero Pardee juxtaposes “old and new material cultures” for Vermont barn conversion

“Here, observation, walking, and seasonal change become active components of the creative cycle,” said the studio.

Verge Select is based in Thornbury, Ontario and was founded in 2009 by Michael Curtis. The studio specialises in architectural, furniture, lighting and interior design.

Other recent studio projects include a Vermont barn conversion for a photographer and painter and a garden studio in London by Delve Architects.

The post Verge Select connects three weathering-steel volumes for Ontario painting studio appeared first on Dezeen.

Construction material costs set to rise if Strait of Hormuz blockade continues

Lizzie Crook · Dezeen Architecture

The continued blockade of the Strait of Hormuz could push up prices of building materials, including steel and cement, a study by global construction consultant Linesight has warned.

If disruption continues in the Strait of Hormuz – a narrow waterway between Iran and the UAE – the construction industry should prepare for higher prices for aluminium, steel, copper and cement, the report states.

Iran is currently restricting access to the waterway used to ship a fifth of the world's oil supply following US and Israeli strikes on the country creating a bottleneck for the oil and gas trade.

The blockade is pushing energy and shipping costs higher, which is expected to have a knock-on effect on the production and transport costs of construction materials.

According to Linesight, this crisis exacerbates the ongoing impact of conflict in the region, including disruption to the Red Sea-Suez trade route.

“Recent disruption is not about a single event, it is the accumulation of energy volatility, constrained logistics and geopolitical risk across multiple routes,” said Linesight's vice president Derek McNamara in the report.

Blockade could have greatest impact on aluminium

In its analysis, Linesight said the chokepoint could have an especially large impact on the cost of aluminium, the second most widely used metal in construction after steel.

This is largely due to Gulf countries producing approximately nine per cent of the global supply, predominantly for export, while relying on imports of bauxite and alumina to produce it.

Suspended gas supplies also caused a smelter used to make aluminium in Qatar to stop operations on 3 March, while the Aluminium Bahrain smelter has also halted shipping, according to the report.

Steel is also likely to be impacted by escalating energy prices and tighter supply, as steelmaking is energy-intensive and furnaces rely heavily on fuels such as gas.

Read:

Over 40,000 civilian buildings in Iran reportedly damaged in ongoing war

Similarly, rising energy costs are feeding through into higher cement production costs due to the material's energy-hungry manufacturing process. Cement is also heavy to transport, meaning an increase in shipping costs from

disrupted and diverted routes is expected to drive the material's price up further.

“A short-lived disruption may be absorbed, but a prolonged period of elevated energy and freight costs would reset cement price baselines across regions,” the report states.

While the Gulf region doesn't produce much copper, it is a leading supplier of sulphur, a byproduct of oil and gas production that is essential for sulphuric acid used in copper ore processing.

Linesight said the war has put “nearly half of global sulphur exports at risk”, meaning copper smelters face potential shortages of acid, hastening the rise of copper prices.

US-Israeli strikes have damaged over 40,000 civilian buildings

In a report by the BBC, the effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz by Iran has hiked the price of a barrel of oil to above \$100 (£74.87) this morning.

The concerns in Linesight's report are echoed by UK building material supplier Travis Perkins, which has said it is considering raising prices.

“In the last week or so, we've had communications from various manufacturing suppliers of ours saying they're looking at energy surcharges or they're looking at price increases to counteract energy rises,” said Travis Perkins CEO Gavin Slark.

Read:

The current wave of US-Israeli strikes on Iran began on February 28, killing Iranian supreme leader Ali Khamenei. Iran has retaliated with missile and drone strikes on Israeli and US-allied countries and bases across the Middle East.

Analysis by the humanitarian group Iranian Red Crescent Society has found that 42,914 civilian buildings in Iran have been damaged by US-Israeli airstrikes. Iranian strikes have also caused damage to notable buildings across the Middle East.

The main image is courtesy of Shutterstock.

The post Construction material costs set to rise if Strait of Hormuz blockade continues appeared first on Dezeen.

NASA accelerates plan to build permanent moon base

Ellen Eberhardt · Dezeen Architecture

NASA has announced that it has cancelled an upcoming orbital space station to expedite the building of a permanent lunar base on the moon, “landing by landing and incrementally”.

Announced on 24 March, the shift in focus is part of agency-wide strategies to hurriedly “achieve President Donald Trump’s National Space Policy and advance American leadership in space”, according to NASA.

The lunar base will feature three major stations according to the space agency, with a reported \$20 billion allocated to the cause over the next seven years. It will use components from the now-cancelled Lunar Gateway, an orbital station that was designed to support moon missions.

“NASA is committed to achieving the near-impossible once again, to return to the Moon before the end of President Trump’s term, build a Moon base, establish an enduring presence, and do the other things needed to ensure American leadership in space,” said NASA administrator Jared Isaacman.

“If we concentrate NASA’s extraordinary resources on the objectives of the National Space Policy, clear away obstacles that impede progress, and unleash the workforce and industrial might of our nation and partners, then returning to the Moon and building a base will seem pale in comparison to what we will be capable of accomplishing in the years ahead.”

“We are shifting to a focused, phased architecture”

A rendering of the base shows astronauts walking on the moon’s surface. Capsules are positioned in groups.

Solar panels, trucks, rockets and landers are all distributed around the base, while spacecrafts float in the distance.

According to NASA, the moon base will be built in three major phases.

The first phase will focus on building the frequency of missions and delivering rovers and utilities, such as power generation, to “build, test and learn”.

The second phase will focus on establishing “semi-habitable” infrastructure.

Read:

“They’ll be flying in our baby” says Artemis II spaceship’s architect

Finally, the third phase “will deliver heavier infrastructure needed for a continuous human foothold on the Moon”, according to NASA.

The initiative is largely supported by the organisation’s ongoing Artemis program, which is focused on returning humans to the moon for long-term habitation. NASA said several constraints to current strategies shifted their approach to the mission, such as a lack of intermediate testing “from a lunar flyby to a lunar landing”.

“On the Moon, we are shifting to a focused, phased architecture that builds capability landing by landing, incrementally, and in alignment with our industrial and international partners,” said NASA Associate Administrator Amit Kshatriya.

This updated plan foresees astronauts’ returning to the lunar surface in early 2028 according to the recently updated plan, called Ignition .

Read:

Space architects are preparing for humanity’s return to the moon

NASA is currently planning to launch the much-delayed Artemis II mission, which is designed to fly the first crewed mission around the moon in more than 50 years.

Recently, Dezeen spoke to one of the designers of the Artemis II spacecraft as well as NASA about its goals to return humans to the moon .

President Trump released the Ensuring American Space Superiority executive order in December 2025, which details “leading the world in space exploration and expanding human reach and American presence”.

China is also working towards landing humans on the moon by 2030 , which is in part, fueling a “geopolitical competition” between the two nations, according to Space.com .

In recent years, architects and designers have put forth proposals for lunar buildings as space slowly grows commercialised and more accessible to non-astronauts .

The image is courtesy of NASA

The post NASA accelerates plan to build permanent moon base appeared first on Dezeen .

A Pluggable Solution for API Observability on our PHP System

nickscheiblauber · Flickr Engineering

When people think about tech and innovation, they often talk about the “next generation.”

Just use GraphQL and life will be easier, many will tell you.

The future of cloud-native is Lambda , claim others.

Unfortunately, most of the conversations don’t talk about the question that is most top-of-mind for me: what does the next generation of tools look like for legacy systems ?

As a Senior Engineering Manager for Flickr’s backend team, here’s one of the major issues my team faces: we have a ton of code that engineers need to understand in order to safely and quickly ship changes. Flickr has built a product loved by millions of photographers for nearly two decades and we have some real history in our code base. You can imagine the amount of work it takes to maintain the stability of our large, complex, public-facing API—which impacts not just customers who use our API, but our own web, mobile, and desktop clients.

The difficulty of wrangling a legacy code base is what led us to be interested in Akita , an observability company going after the dream of “one-click” observability. Akita’s first product passively watches API traffic using packet capture (PCAP) to provide automated API monitoring, automatically infer the structure of API endpoints, and automatically detect potential issues and breaking changes. Akita’s goal is to make it possible for organizations like ours, with our hundreds of thousands of lines of legacy code, to understand system behavior in order to move quickly.

But there’s a catch: Akita’s first product, currently in beta, works only for representational state transfer (REST) APIs. Our API at Flickr, nearly twenty years old, coincides with the rise of REST. This blog post focuses on how I used Akita to introduce observability to our code base.

Moving fast with legacy systems

First, let me give some context on high-level responsibilities of backend engineering at Flickr. Since moving Flickr into the cloud two years ago we’ve had more time to focus on modernizing our services and improving our developer experience. This puts us in a much better position to build new features than before—but first, we need to streamline how we get things done, which is not nearly as simple as it sounds.

Today, we serve up around a billion photos daily from millions of photographers. Nearly every Flickr API request executes legacy code in some way—code that is less tested, less documented, and sometimes dangerous to mess with. A great deal of care has to be taken to avoid disruptions. And when new features need to interact with older features, this can get complex fast! On top of all that, we need to find ways to help our small but mighty team focus their limited time

and attention while navigating the old and the new, without the luxury of handing this problem over to an internal tools team.

Our difficulty getting a handle on our legacy systems led us to become excited about using Akita for easy observability. Akita promised to tell us about our API interactions and potential issues with the API, all by passively watching API traffic. But there was, as I mentioned, a catch: Akita works only for REST APIs right now, and our API is... RESTish. Most notably, we never adopted the REST convention of using distinct URL paths for each service endpoint, and we rely heavily on passing parameters through the query string, or form-encoded in POSTs. This situation has historically made it hard for us to use other API tools as well.

Getting Akita to work for my REST-like format

Thankfully our PHP request handlers are plug and play so I quickly whipped up a new proof-of-concept handler showing that we could start getting visibility into our API endpoints and their behavior using Akita. This gave me the ability to generate Akita traces using curl and the Akita command line interface (CLI) tool out of the box, but only within my local dev environment.

Right away I spotted some things to improve, and more ideas came that afternoon. I wanted to put our ``api_key`` parameter into an Authorization header, and remove the ``method`` parameter since I’d used it in a fake service path. Also, our API returns a 200 HTTP Status on errors, including an element ``stat`` indicating failure. I wanted those to be HTTP 400s.

But I had a conundrum: Akita works best when observing production traffic. Real, production API requests at production load will really fill in the nooks and crannies of our API models. My progress showed it would be so worth it to go further, so I met with the Akita team and discussed using their Go-based plugin system to transform our live requests into a desirable format based on my proof-of-concept. It turns out that most of Akita’s tooling is open source and I could work on the plugin myself! This turned out to be the key to making Akita work with our RESTish format.

Fitting into the Go plugin format

Exciting news! I just needed to turn my prototype into something that I could run with the Akita agent every time.

The Akita CLI has a mechanism for dynamically loading plugins, which can operate on the captured and parsed data before it is sent to the Akita cloud. My transformations of the API format into a more REST-like format could be packaged that way.

I soon discovered that I was the first person to try building a third-party plugin. Akita told me that they used the plugin architecture internally to package a non-open-source plugin that infers data formats, but that is compiled into the client.

A shift week

Petr Mitrichev · Petr Mitrichev (competitive programming)

The Dec 22 - Dec 29 week wrapped up the competitive 2025 on the major platforms. The 4th Universal Cup. Stage 10: Grand Prix of Wrocław took place on Saturday (problems , results , top 5 on the left, onsite results , analysis). Team USA1 were not the first to finish, but they were still the fastest overall, and extended their streak of 8 (!) won rounds in a row. Well done!

Codeforces Good Bye 2025 followed the same day (problems , results , top 5 on the left, analysis). While the round lasted 3 hours, the top three needed just two of those to solve all problems. Similar to the above round, being first to finish did not mean first place, though, as Benq was a bit slower on the medium problems and therefore jiangly could overtake him. Congratulations!

I have enjoyed solving the problems and was making good progress, but it was nowhere near as fast, as problem F by itself took me over an hour of iterations, stress testing etc.

AtCoder Grand Contest 076 took place on Sunday (problems , results , top 5 on the left, analysis). It turns out that it was indeed possible to qualify for AWTF with a win after a relatively poor season, only it was noimi and not myself who has achieved that feat. Well done!

Quite unusually for an AGC I was able to solve A very quickly, but did not score any points after that. In problem B, I have empirically discovered that the answer is always 1 or 2, but could not figure out a condition to separate those two cases, not to mention the actual sequence of steps to achieve that number. In problem C my incorrect solutions were quite close to the one described in the editorial by the idea, but not close enough by the details. At the end of the contest, I have tried to solve E as a heuristic problem, trying various greedy approaches with local optimizations on top, also without much success. Well, better luck next year!

Here is that heuristic-inviting problem E : you are given at most 250000 vectors, and need to choose a subset that maximizes the value of (squared length of the sum of the chosen vectors) minus three times (sum of squared lengths of the chosen vectors). Can you find an exact solution?

This round wrapped up the race for the 2026 World Tour Finals (results , top 12 on the left). Everyone with ≥ 100 points qualified, but people had wildly different ways to achieve that amount of points, with some qualifying thanks to a round victory, and some never placing higher than fourth in any particular round. I'm looking forward to yet another exciting final in Japan!

It is also notable that some usual suspects did not qualify this time, including zhoukangyang who was first and first in qualification in the previous two seasons, and first and second in the last two World Tour Finals. Better luck next year as well!

In my previous summary , I have mentioned another AtCoder problem : you are given two sequences of integers a_i and b_i of the same length n up to $2 \cdot 10^5$, $1 \leq b_i$, where $\gg$ denotes the bitwise shift right. How many of the $n!$ permutations yield the smallest possible value of that sum? You need to print the answer modulo 998244353.

First, let us sort both arrays, so we can assume they are sorted below. Intuitively, it feels that all permutations of a_i that deliver the minimum must be sorted or almost sorted. To make further progress, we can either implement a brute force approach to find out experimentally what does almost mean exactly, or make the intuitive argument more formal, with the same goal.

Suppose we have only two elements. If $a_0 = a_1$ or $b_0 = b_1$, then they can be swapped freely without changing our target value. Now consider the case when they are distinct: $a_0 > b_0$, $q = a_1 \gg b_0$, and $r = b_1 - b_0$. Then we need the following to be true: $p + q \gg r = q + p \gg r$, which is equivalent to $q - p = q \gg r - p \gg r$.

What happens to the difference of two numbers if we cut their last bit? It is not hard to check that it stays the same in only one case: if the bigger number was even, and exactly 1 higher than the smaller number. In all other cases it becomes smaller. So for the above condition to be true, we need $q = p + 1$ and q divisible by 2^r . These are the only cases where two distinct numbers can be swapped without increasing our target value.

Now we will consider our arrays in blocks of equal b_i . Consider the first such block: $b_0 = b_1 = \dots = b_{k-1} = 0$, $b_k > 0$.

Denote $x = a_k$ if k is even, and a_{k+1} otherwise. Therefore x is always even. From the above argument, the only swaps we can do between this block and the rest of the array is swapping the values $x-1$ from the block with the values x outside the block.

Let us denote c as the number of i such that $a_i = x-1$ and $i = k$, e as the number of i such that $a_i = x$ and $i = k$. Note that we always have either $d = 0$, or $e = 0$, or both.

Suppose we decided to do g swaps of the above form ($x-1$ from the block with x from the rest). Then we have ($c+d$ choose $c-g$) ways to choose which values $x-1$ go inside the block, ($e+f$ choose $e+g$) ways to choose which values x go inside the block, and (k factorial) ways to permute the values inside the block. We need to multiply those three numbers by the answer for the remaining subproblem, which is considering the arrays starting from the position k , such that g values of x have been replaced with $x-1$, and we must make sure that those replaced values all end up in the next r blocks, where r is the number of 0s at the end of the binary representation of x .

Now, what happens when we consider the next block, the one where $b_i = 1$? We can now shift all values a_i right by 1, and denote $y = x \gg 1$ (remember that x is even), and

“There is no message in what I do” says Pritzker Architecture Prize-winner Smiljan Radić

Ben Dreith · Dezeen Architecture

Elusive architect Smiljan Radić explains how his work should not be seen as a blueprint for “good or bad” architecture, in this exclusive interview following his “surprise” Pritzker Architecture Prize win .

Radić, who became the 55th Pritzker Architecture Prize laureate earlier this month, said that although he’s always wanted his work to have a global impact, the win was “a great surprise”.

“I have always wanted my work to be part of a global discussion,” Radić told Dezeen.

“In concrete terms, that discussion means being concerned with the opinion of a small group of architects and artists with whom I occasionally exchange ideas and can establish a real dialogue.”

Smiljan Radić is known for his enigmatic and metaphorical work, such as the House for the Poem of the Right Angle in Vilches

His vision of architecture, like his output, is condensed, patient and heavily curated.

Although he has been highly regarded in architecture circles, Radić has not completed numerous high-profile cultural buildings like many other Pritzker laureates.

Perhaps his best-known project internationally was his 2014 Serpentine Pavilion .

Much of Radić’s experimentation has been conducted in his residential architecture projects, such as Piedra Roja

Winning the Pritzker Architecture Prize, considered the highest prize in the field, has moved Radić more into the mainstream, with magazines and newspapers displaying his name and images all over the world. However, he does not want his work, which is heavily metaphorical, to be morally instructive.

“There is no message in what I do,” he said.

“I’m not interested in it becoming a kind of sermon about what is good or bad in architecture.”

Read:

The architect remains very private. His firm, Smiljan Radić Clark, does not have a website, and the architect does not use social media, something he says is intentional and fundamentally disuseful for his project.

“It does not offer a kind of communication that I find meaningful,” he said of social media.

“I am not against it; I simply do not use it, as I do not consider it a useful tool for the kind of work I do. It is as

if someone gave you a drill and you felt compelled to make holes everywhere.”

Radić has been influenced by radical architecture and the “fragility” of certain Chilean structures

The prize’s announcement was delayed after revelations that its chairman, Tom Pritzker, featured heavily in the tranche of emails associated with convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. Yet, Radić was announced anyway, just a week later than in 2025.

In the face of this contentious year, when the future of the prize has been thrown into question , Radić maintained the integrity of the award. He said he has trust in the jury, which was chaired by Alejandro Aravena , the only other Chilean to have won the Pritzker Architecture Prize.

“I found out about the award in mid-January,” said Radić, echoing sentiments he relayed to CNN earlier this month.

“I’ve spent the last 30 years working out of a small office, pushing to do the best possible within whatever conditions were on the table. Architecture has always been the obsession.”

“I still believe it’s a fundamentally positive act – and I continue to believe that the Pritzker Prize remains part of that positive act despite the circumstances. In the end, I trust the jury to hold that line.”

Read:

Smiljan Radić creates inflatable stage for Chile’s architecture biennial

Being honoured with the prize has also caused Radić to reflect on his career, which started after he graduated from the Catholic University of Chile in 1989. He founded his studio in Santiago in 1995 and worked on a number of houses, cultural institutions and temporary structures throughout the 2000s and 2010s.

His “obsession” with architecture is rooted in what he calls “radical” or “improbable realities” in the field, work that he collects in a database called associated with his institution, the Fundación de Arquitectura Frágil or Fragile Architecture Foundation.

The architect is perhaps best known for his 2014 Serpentine Pavilion

He mentioned that he is currently reading the work of conceptual architect John Hejduk, but also credited his time travelling around Europe to experience the work of architects, contemporary and historical, as his “real beginnings”.

“I should say that my real beginnings go back to when I was studying in Venice in the 1990s,” he said.

“At that time, I traveled to Portugal to experience firsthand the work of Álvaro Siza . and later the buildings of Francesco

Safer Internet Day and Open Source Codes of Conduct

Sarah Graywood · Flickr Engineering

Last week the world celebrated Safer Internet Day , a day used to call upon stakeholders to join together to make the internet a safer and better place for all, and especially for children and young people. Here at Flickr, we believe in creating spaces on the internet that take into account the safety of all of our contributors, especially our youngest and most underrepresented. So, to celebrate that and to continue the work of making our spaces safer and more accessible to all, we have added a code of conduct to our most trafficked open source repositories on GitHub.

What's/Why Open Source?

“100_0509” by Nick Quaranto is licensed under CC BY-SA 2.0

Open source is a method of development that allows software to be available publicly so that contributors can modify, add, and remove code as they see fit in order to create a more robust codebase colored with the ideas and innovations of many developers rather than just a few. At Flickr we believe that innovation happens when we have a diverse and widespread set of voices coming together to suggest changes. Open source allows us to harness the power of these voices to create the very best software we can.

Flickr has 15 open source repositories, 4 of which are actively contributed to. Of those four, none had a formal code of conduct to govern contributions to the code base or interpersonal interactions between developers actively working on the code... until now!

Why a code of conduct?

Codes of conduct are extremely common and important in the open source community. Groups like Linux, Homebrew, Bootstrap, and Kubernetes all have codes of conduct governing the use of and contributions to their open source projects. Because open source allows such a diverse set of voices to express themselves, conflicts can arise and unfortunately not all come with the best of intent.

“Bullying” by Senado Federal is licensed under CC by 2.0

Codes of conduct allow us to have a preconceived understanding of what interactions in our community are meant to look like and why we hold these expectations of members. Codes of conduct can range from what is expected of interpersonal interactions (e.g. Demonstrate kindness and empathy toward other developers in pull request reviews) to more generalized expectations (e.g. Focus on what is best for the community as a whole rather than individual desires or needs). Codes of conduct not only benefit the community in its entirety, but also allow us to focus on protecting the psychological safety of members of our community who are most at risk. We care about all of our members while also recognizing the need for specific and directed language to protect members of underrepresented groups. The best

way to do this is to have a written code of conduct with specific, actionable steps used to govern the safety of the community.

Why Contributor Covenant?

In order to protect underrepresented groups and to foster a strong and healthy open source community here at Flickr, we thought about whether it would be best to write our own code of conduct specifically tailored to what we value at Flickr or whether it would be better to find a code of conduct already in use that we could use to guide our own open source communities. We ended up finding a code of conduct already in use by quite a few well respected organizations that directly spoke to our most important operating principles .

Contributor Covenant is a code of conduct for participating in open source communities which explicitly outlines expectations in order to create a healthy open source culture. Contributor Covenant has been adopted by over a hundred thousand open source communities and projects since 2014 and is used by Linux, Babel, Bootstrap, Kubernetes, code.gov, Twilio, Homebrew-Cask, and Target to name a few. With such well-respected organizations turning to Contributor Covenant, it was something we thought we would be foolish not to consider.

As we considered, we realized that Contributor Covenant had all of our values specified in a wonderful document that was only a little over a page long . Both accessible in its readability and shortness and robust enough to do the job of protecting underrepresented contributors on our open source repositories, we had found a perfect marriage of all of the things that we wanted in a code of conduct, while also allowing us to become part of a large scale community adopting a singular vision for a healthy, safe, and innovative open source community.

PichiAvo builds wooden temple to burn down for Valencia’s Fallas festival

Amy Peacock · Dezeen Architecture

Local art studio PichiAvo used wood and paper to create a pavilion based on an Ancient Greek temple, which was set ablaze for the Fallas celebrations in Valencia .

Named Per Ofrenar, which means “to offer” in Catalan, the installation had a classical design that drew upon the Temple of Athena Nike in Athens .

PichiAvo designed a temple-like pavilion to be burnt as part of Fallas festival

PichiAvo designed Per Ofrenar for Fallas, an annual five-day festival where wood and paper monuments are exhibited in the streets of Valencia before being set on fire on the final day, La Cremà, which was on 19 March.

Installed on a street in the centre of the city, its walls, roof and plinth were constructed from wood, while surplus paper from a book by PichiAvo was used for the capitals

and bases of the pavilion’s Ionic columns.

Inside, two candles were placed atop stacks of PichiAvo’s surplus paper, which was arranged to form an altar-like space.

Fallas monuments often have sculptural designs that take the shape of satirical figures, but PichiAvo wanted to design a place for people to gather and leave religious offerings.

Read:

“Per Ofrenar means ‘to offer’, in the sense of making a symbolic, spiritual, or religious offering,” PichiAvo founders Juan Antonio Sánchez and Álvaro Hernández told Dezeen.

“We wanted to create a space specifically designed for that act, a place people could physically enter and leave an offering to the deities.”

Graffiti was written on the walls of the temple during the festival

The Big Dune

Stu Davidson · Stuck in Customs

Daily Photo – The Big Dune

I got one of those Google reminders today of an image from the past and it sent me down a little rabbit hole on my Smugmug portfolio. One of the little branches ended up at this image which quite connected with me today for some reason, so I thought I’d share. Maybe it’s because it is the middle of winter where I am... who knows. Whatever the case, I hope it gives you a little bit of joy in your day too.

Date Taken 2014-09-25 20:55:45

Camera ILCE-7R

Exposure Time 1/2500

Aperture 4

ISO 100

Focal Length 70.0 mm

Flash Off, Did not fire

Exposure Program Aperture-priority AE

Exposure Bias +0.3

The post The Big Dune appeared first on Stuck in Customs .

IN BRIEF

Fashionista, Fashionista: In case you missed them, we’ve rounded up our most popular stories of the week to help you stay in the loop. No need to thank us — just toast a cappuccino in our honor when you’re discussing who did what over your pain au chocolat. Homepage photo: Bryan Bedder/Getty Images for Fashion Scholarship ...

Continue reading

Valentina Díaz, ArchDaily: © Federico Cairoli

architects: Lezaeta Lavanchy

Location: Trapiche, Argentina

Project Year: 2023

Photographs: Federico Cairoli

Area: 110.0 m2

Read more »

Hadir Al Koshta, ArchDaily: © Alex Shoots Buildings

architects: System Recovery Architects

Location: Strážné, Czechia

Project Year: 2025

Photographs: Alex Shoots Buildings

Photographs: Vítězslav Kůstka

Area: 293.0 m2

Read more »

Valentina Díaz, ArchDaily: © Daniela Mac Adden

architects: Luciano Kruk

Location: São Paulo, Brasil

Project Year: 2019

Photographs: Daniela Mac Adden

Area: 753.0 m2

Read more »

Winnie Liu, Fashionista: Paul Wilmot Communications is looking for an ambitious and enthusiastic Senior Account Executive to join its thriving Beauty & Wellness team. The ideal candidate will lead media strategies with a focus on brand launches, features, product placement, executive profiles, and strategic brand ...

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David Hobby, Strobist: The Paul C. Buff Link monobloc studio strobe (\$895.95) delivers 800ws of portable power, and deserves consideration from anyone in the United States who is considering a big gun for use on location.

Please note: This is not a full review.

David Hobby, Strobist: The Paul C. Buff Link monobloc studio strobe (\$895.95) delivers 800ws of portable power, and deserves consideration from anyone in the United States who is considering a big gun for use on location.

Please note: This is not a full review.

It was made from wood and excess paper from a book by PichiAvo Inside, two candles were placed atop stacks of PichiAvo's surplus paper, which was arranged to form an altar-like space.

Amy Peacock

Kéré Architecture designs perforated brick health clinic in Burundi

Tom Ravenscroft · Dezeen Architecture

Berlin studio Kéré Architecture has revealed its design for the Ineza Clinic, which will step up a hillside in rural Burundi within a series of brick pavilions.

Designed for the city of Bubanza, around 30 miles north of Burundi's capital, the health centre will be built from predominantly local materials to reduce the cost of transportation.

Kéré Architecture has designed the Ineza Clinic in Burundi

Taking advantage of the site's topography, the health facility will consist of 10 buildings arranged on either side of a zigzagging road that progresses up a hill. Kéré Architecture said this arrangement will also facilitate cross ventilation.

At the base of the slope, visitors will arrive at a small entrance pavilion, before coming to a cafe and toilet block.

The health centre will be made up of 10 separate buildings

Halfway up the hill, the larger wards, treatment blocks and outpatient units each tend along the hillside from the main drive.

Finally, at the top of the hill is a trio of housing blocks for visitors, with a lounge topping the site.

It will be predominantly built from local materials

Before designing the facility, the studio visited brick factories, welding workshops and wood-processing

plants in the surrounding area to map out local resources.

All of the clinic's buildings will share a similar aesthetic, with locally sourced brick walls broken by perforated sections to allow light and air to enter.

They will be crowned with monopitch roofs wrapped with vertical timber batons, raised on retaining walls of stone sourced from nearby quarries.

It was designed to take advantage of cross ventilation

"In a place where travelling less than forty kilometres can take up to three hours because of poor road conditions, having a clinic in close proximity is vital for survival," said Kéré Architecture.

"This clinic in Bubanza makes that difference. When you imagine a pregnant woman in the back of an ambulance, trying to reach care over those roads, you begin to understand just how essential nearby access to medical treatment is for the community."

Work on the clinic has begun

Work on the health facility has already begun, with the first stage of the clinic set to open later this year.

According to the studio, the project was heavily informed by its own Léo Surgical Clinic and Health Centre in Burkina Faso, which was one of 10 of the architect's significant buildings we included in a roundup to mark Kéré winning the Pritzker Architec-

An alumni day

Petr Mitrichev · Petr Mitrichev (competitive programming)

The Alumni Talk and the Opening Ceremony were the main events of the ICPC World Finals 2025 today. Among other things, they demonstrated two of the best careers (according to my own perception, of course :) that the ICPC crowd can choose: the Alumni Talk was about fundamental computer science research, in this case of the core graph shortest path algorithms, while the Opening Ceremony introduced two new sponsors, Google DeepMind and OpenAI, which represent just as cutting-edge but more practical ML/AI research. On a more meta note, it is fascinating how from talking with different ICPC participants and alumni, there are those that consider it an important career step to one of the above fields, there are also those who really want to win it or get a medal, but there are also those who are here to have fun and mingle with like-minded people, and the event works great for all of them. Well done to the organizers!

Another highlight of this year is a series of alumni events which are not on the main schedule, but for me personally look more interesting than many of the main events. If you're onsite in Baku, come chat with us, in particular I will be hosting on Wednesday at 17:30! I am also looking for a topic for my session, even though "Meet and Greet" also works. One topic that flows naturally from this blog is something like "blogging in the age of TikTok and Discord", but

I'm not sure if it is the most interesting one :)

The ICPC Quest today asked us to go back to the old photos in the ICPC photo gallery. My photos in the ICPC photo gallery do start with my first participation in 2003 in Beverly Hills, and you can see the one I like the most from that year on the left.

Thanks for reading, and check back tomorrow for more #ICPCBaku updates!

A chess day

Petr Mitrichev · Petr Mitrichev (competitive programming)

Yesterday was the day of the Dress Rehearsal and the Tech Trek at #ICPCBaku. I am planning to solve the mirror contest on Thursday together with Kevin and Mateusz, so we used the Dress Rehearsal time to practice our solving and streaming setup as well (photo on the left). Unfortunately we could not practice the submissions since it seems that the mirror was not available for the Dress Rehearsal, but the rest seems in order. Tune in tomorrow (Thursday) at 11:00 Baku time to my Twitch to watch us compete! You will also be able to look at the official broadcast of the real contest, its scoreboard and problems (you can find more links here), and of course please support the #ETH team!

Today is the ICPC Challenge day, with the results due to be announced in a couple of hours. In the evening the Alumni-hosted events will continue, and I have decided to use my slot for an online chess tournament for the World Finals onsite attendees. Here is how I propose to run it:

We will run a 5-round Swiss tournament on lichess with 3+0 time control (3 minutes for each side per game, no increment). This yields a 30-minute duration but if games finish earlier hopefully it will be a bit faster and everybody will be in time for the push-ups :)

To join the tournament, you need a lichess account and a phone or a laptop to play. If you do not have a lichess account and want to partic-

ipate, please create it in advance!

To join the tournament, you also need to join this team on lichess first. I will need to approve everybody who wants to join the team so that it keeps being an onsite event, so you will need to find me in person for that.

The easiest way to find me in person will be to come to the Chill Zone in the Marriott Blvd today at 17:30 (or a bit earlier).

The tournament will start at 17:35, so don't be late! If you are late, you should be able to join the tournament late during the first two rounds as well, but then you will miss some games :)

If you have any questions, please ask in comments here or on Codeforces!

Over 40,000 civilian buildings in Iran reportedly damaged in ongoing war

Amy Peacock · Dezeen Architecture

Humanitarian group Iranian Red Crescent Society has reported that 42,914 civilian buildings in Iran have been damaged by US-Israeli airstrikes, including more than 36,000 homes.

Announced on X last week, the Iranian Red Crescent Society – a non-governmental group affiliated with the International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC) – calculated that US-Israeli airstrikes have caused damage to 42,914 civilian buildings in Iran.

This includes 36,489 residential units and 6,179 commercial units.

A number of cultural heritage sites have been damaged in Iran by US-Israeli airstrikes since the recent war broke out. Last week, the Iranian government announced on X that “at least 56 museums, historical monuments, and cultural sites have sustained serious damage”.

Among them is the UNESCO World Heritage-listed Golestan Palace in Tehran, which is thought to have been damaged by shock waves and debris from a nearby missile strike.

Historic buildings in Isfahan have sustained damage, including the Chehel Sotoon Palace, the Ali Qapu Palace and the Jameh Mosque. In Khorramabad, buildings situated near the buffer zone of the prehistoric Khorramabad Valley have been damaged, as well as the Falak-ol-Aflak Castle.

Read:

US-Israeli airstrike damages UNESCO-listed palace in Tehran

Iranian strikes have also caused damage to notable buildings across the Middle East. In Dubai, debris from an intercepted Iranian drone caused a fire at the Burj Al Arab skyscraper, and an intercepted missile caused a fire on the man-made Palm Jumeirah island.

Strikes in the Middle East have also reportedly caused damage to the White City of Tel-Aviv in Israel and Tyre in Lebanon, which are UNESCO-listed sites.

“UNESCO has communicated and will continue to communicate to all parties concerned the geographical coordinates of sites on the World Heritage List, the national Tentative Lists, as well as those under Enhanced Protection, to take all feasible precautions to avoid damage,” said UNESCO.

The current wave of strikes and counterstrikes began on February 28, when the USA and Israel launched airstrikes on Iran, killing Iranian supreme leader Ali Khamenei. Iran retaliated with missile and drone strikes on Israeli and US-allied countries and bases across the Middle East, and the war in the region is ongoing.

The photo is by the Iranian Red Crescent Society.

The post Over 40,000 civilian buildings in Iran reportedly damaged in ongoing war appeared first on Dezeen

Strikes in the Middle East have also reportedly caused damage to the White City of Tel-Aviv in Israel and Tyre in Lebanon , which are UNESCO-listed sites.

Amy Peacock

This week we interviewed Pritzker Architecture Prize-winner Smiljan Radić

Tom Ravenscroft · Dezeen Architecture

This week on Dezeen, we spoke to elusive architect Smiljan Radić about his “surprise” Pritzker Architecture Prize win.

Radić explained how he was surprised by the win and didn’t want his work to be seen as a blueprint for “good or bad” architecture.

“There is no message in what I do,” he said. “I’m not interested in it becoming a kind of sermon about what is good or bad in architecture.”

We spoke to Marc Newson

We also spoke to Australian designer Marc Newson about his 40-year career in an exclusive interview at his retrospective show at Château La Coste in the south of France.

Newson, who designed the most expensive work ever sold at auction by a living designer, talked to Dezeen about quality and affordability. “Anything good is kind of costly,” he said.

The World Cup host countries revealed their kits

In other design news, the kits that the trio of host nations will wear at the World Cup later this year were revealed. The US home shirts have bold red stripes, while the jerseys for Mexico pay homage to Aztec sculpture.

We also revealed the England World Cup kits, which Nike described as “unapologetically English”.

We reported on Africa’s skyscraper mini-boom

As Africa experiences a mini-boom in skyscraper construction, we investigated why towers are rising across the continent in countries including Egypt, Ethiopia and Ivory Coast.

We asked – is this spate of construction cause for alarm?

Multiple construction contracts for work on Neom in Saudi Arabia have been cancelled

We also reported that multiple construction contracts for work on the Neom mega project in Saudi Arabia had been cancelled.

Steel company Eversendai, Italian contractor Webuild and Hyundai Engineering and Construction all recently announced that their contracts had been terminated.

A cork-clad loft extension was one of this week’s most popular projects

Popular projects on Dezeen this week included a cork-clad loft extension in London, a timber-lined house in the Netherlands and a home on a Washington island.

Listen to our journalists talk about the key design and architecture stories of the past seven days on our Dezeen Weekly podcast, which this week focused on the AIA’s legal action against Donald Trump.

This week on Dezeen

This week on Dezeen is our regular roundup of the week’s top news stories. Subscribe to our newsletters to be sure you don’t miss anything.

SLC-2L-12: Two-Light Bike for the Bucks

David Hobby · Strobist

UPDATE: The bike sold, quickly, for the full asking price to the first person who showed up. Which was cool. And even better, the guy was like, “Who did the pictures? They jumped out at me.”

(Tiny speedlights FTW...)

Have you tried to buy a new bike lately? Or even a used bike?

The coronavirus pandemic has made them very tough to find. Between home-bound people snapping them up and all of the various broken supply chains, most of the bike inventory — other than very pricey specialty bikes — has pretty much vanished.

Which means that if you have a functional bike in your garage that you don’t need, it will likely never be worth more than it is right now.

My daughter Emily has an unneeded bike in the garage. It’s a Trek 7100, which is decent hybrid. She rode it to middle school. But she’s just graduated college and won’t be bringing it to her new job.

But right now it should fetch a nice price in the Craigslist Bicycle Hunger Games. Especially if it is photographed and presented well.

So that’s exactly what we are going to do today: photograph a bike with a basic two speedlight kit. Read more »

Between homebound people snapping them up and all of the various broken supply chains, most of the bike inventory — other than very pricey specialty bikes — has pretty much vanished.

David Hobby

A winter week

Petr Mitrichev · Petr Mitrichev (competitive programming)

The last weekend was packed with contests. First off, the Yandex Cup 2025 onsite final took place in Istanbul early on Saturday (results , top 5 on the left). The usual suspects topped the scoreboard, and Kevin got the highest score in each problem and earned the well-deserved first place. Congratulations!

This was already the 10th cphof-worthy contest of 2025, and with the addition of the upcoming Hacker Cup and the completed without published results TopCoder Marathon Match Tournament (yes, TopCoder is still around! But does anybody know what happened to the results?) it could be 12. That is a big improvement over the recent years, and the overall record of 17 per year in 2016 does not look too far away. Huge thanks to all organizers, and I'm looking forward to the 2026 editions!

Codeforces Round 1069, which reused some of the problems of the Yandex final, took place in parallel (problems , results , top 5 on the left, analysis). A Kevin won here as well, solving problem D with just 6 minutes remaining in the round. Kudos for the perseverance!

The Universal Cup Grand Prix of Poland also took place on Saturday (problems , results , top 5 on the left). The first Kevin, together with his teammates, needed less than half of the contest to wrap things up, almost 90 minutes faster than everybody else. The

closest pursuers were the other veteran teams Almost Retired Dandelion and Amstelpark, and I am of course partial to seeing veteran teams perform well. Congratulations!

The M(IT)^2 25-26 Winter Contest followed on Sunday, starting with the Individual Round (problems , results , top 5 on the left, analysis). The second Kevin came out ahead this time, but he had to wait anxiously for quite some time since Gennady had a big penalty time advantage after the first four problems, and therefore could afford to solve the fifth problem twenty minutes later but still win. This did not happen, so congratulations on the victory!

The easiest problem turned out to be (relatively) challenging for me, as I used 12 minutes to get it right while some others needed only 3. It went like this: you are given a string of length

The Team Round followed a few hours later (problems , results , top 5 on the left, analysis , award ceremony stream). Finally, no Kevins in the first place: team T1 had Jaehyun , Gennady and Sunghyeon instead. Congratulations!

Thanks for reading, and check back next week!

Our Justified Layout Goes Open Source

jimwhimpey · Flickr Engineering

We introduced the justified layout on Flickr.com late in 2011. Our community of photographers loved it for its ability to efficiently display many photos at their native aspect ratio with visually pleasing, consistent whitespace, so we quickly added it to the rest of the website.

It's been through many iterations and optimizations. From back when we were primarily on the PHP stack to our lovely new JavaScript based isomorphic stack. Last year Eric Socolofsky did a great job explaining how the algorithm works and how it fits into a larger infrastructure for Flickr specifically.

In the years following its launch, we've had requests from our front end colleagues in other teams across Yahoo for a reusable package that does photo (or any rectangle) presentation like this, but it's always been too tightly coupled to our stack to separate it out and hand it over. Until now! Today we're publishing the justified-layout algorithm wrapped in an npm module for you to use on the server, or client, in your own projects.

Install/Download

npm install justified-layout --save

Or grab it directly from Github .

Using it

It's really easy to use. No configuration is required. Just pass in an array of aspect ratios representing the

photos/boxes you'd like to lay out:

```
var layoutGeometry =
  require('justified-layout')
  ([1.33, 1, 0.65] [, config]);
```

If you only have dimensions and don't want an extra step to convert them to aspect ratios, you can pass in an array of widths and heights like this:

```
https://gist.github.com/
jimwhimpey/825377b78ef8
d9b10e702aa6adc41eb4
```

What it returns

The geometry data for the layout items, in the same order they're passed in.

```
https://gist.github.com/
jimwhimpey/faaf2c
95809647abcbea481d8445
ecf9
```

This is the extent of what the module provides. There's no rendering component. It's up to you to use this data to render boxes the way you want. Use absolute positioning, background positions, canvas, generate a static image on the backend, whatever you like! There's a very basic implementation used on the demo and docs page .

It's highly likely the defaults don't satisfy your requirements; they don't even satisfy ours. There's a full set of configuration options to customize the output just the way you want. My favorite is the fullWidthBreakoutRowCadence option that we use on album pages . All config options are documented on the docs and demo page .

IE 9+

Node 0.10+

Kudos for the perseverance! The Universal Cup Grand Prix of Poland also took place on Saturday (problems , results , top 5 on the left).

Petr Mitrichev

At the end of the contest, we tried to add some heuristics to speed up our matching code in B, but it was still too slow.

Petr Mitrichev

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